Grade 4 ELA

Literature and Reading Comprehension

Common Core-aligned question bank • RL.4.1–RL.4.10

150 Multiple-Choice Questions

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Includes an answer key. Answer options are randomized independently for each question.

Skills include textual evidence, inference, theme, summary, plot, character development, point of view, figurative language, and comparing literary works.

Easy Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

1. What is the setting of a story?

A. The problem's solution
B. Where and when the story happens
C. The lesson the story teaches
D. The list of characters

2. Who is a character in a story?

A. The lesson at the end
B. A person or animal in the story
C. The place where it happens
D. The title of the book

3. What is the plot?

A. The book's cover
B. The author's name
C. The events that happen in a story
D. The list of chapters

4. What is a theme?

A. A message or lesson about life
B. The page number
C. The story's setting only
D. A character's name

5. What does it mean to make an inference?

A. Guess without any clues
B. Copy a sentence exactly
C. Use clues and what you know to figure something out
D. Read only the title

6. What is a narrator?

A. The person who draws pictures
B. The person who buys the book
C. The main problem
D. The voice that tells the story

7. Which detail best describes a character?

A. The curtain was blue.
B. The stage was made of wood.
C. The story happened on Friday.
D. Her hands shook as she stepped onto the stage.

8. What is dialogue?

A. A list of events
B. Words spoken by characters
C. The lesson learned
D. The story's setting

9. What is a problem in a story?

A. The place where a character lives
B. The story's title
C. A challenge a character faces
D. The author's biography

10. What is a solution in a story?

A. The first sentence
B. The time of day
C. The main character's name
D. How the problem is resolved

11. Which phrase is an example of a simile?

A. the classroom was a zoo
B. as quiet as a mouse
C. the wind whispered
D. the angry storm

12. Which phrase is an example of a metaphor?

A. Her voice was music.
B. as cold as ice
C. as busy as a bee
D. like a bright star

13. What is personification?

A. Using a question mark
B. Giving human actions or qualities to something nonhuman
C. Comparing using “like” or “as”
D. Repeating a word

14. What is the point of view?

A. The perspective from which a story is told
B. The story's title
C. The author's age
D. The number of characters

15. In first-person narration, which word might the narrator use?

A. I
B. She
C. He
D. They

16. Which sentence is in third-person point of view?

A. Let us carry our backpacks.
B. We carried our backpacks to school.
C. I carried my backpack to school.
D. Lena carried her backpack to school.

17. What is a summary?

A. A list of difficult words
B. Every detail copied from a story
C. An opinion about the cover
D. A short retelling of the most important events or ideas

18. What does a character's motivation explain?

A. Where the story is printed
B. How long the book is
C. Who illustrated the book
D. Why the character acts a certain way

19. Which detail is evidence that a character is nervous?

A. He walked to the library.
B. He wore a green shirt.
C. He tapped his foot and twisted his fingers.
D. The room had two windows.

20. What is a conflict in a story?

A. A book review
B. A rhyming word
C. A chapter heading
D. A struggle or problem

21. What does a chapter heading usually tell you?

A. The story's ending for certain
B. How many characters there are
C. What that section may be about
D. The author's home address

22. Which is an example of a realistic-fiction character?

A. A talking mountain that grants wishes
B. A dragon who controls the moon
C. A child learning to ride a bicycle
D. A wizard who travels through time

23. Which is most likely fantasy?

A. A student joining a soccer team
B. A child helping in a garden
C. A family moving to a new town
D. A rabbit that talks and attends school

24. What is a fable?

A. A list of facts about planets
B. A short story that often teaches a lesson
C. A poem with no characters
D. A set of instructions

25. What is a folktale?

A. A science experiment
B. A personal shopping list
C. A traditional story passed down through generations
D. A daily weather report

26. What is a poem?

A. A book that must be true
B. Writing that may use rhythm, sound, and carefully chosen words
C. A set of directions only
D. A list of dates

27. What is a stanza?

A. A paragraph of dialogue only
B. A group of lines in a poem
C. A story's main character
D. A book's cover

28. Which word is an example of onomatopoeia?

A. blue
B. below
C. buzz
D. bright

29. What does “the leaves danced” most likely mean?

A. The leaves wore shoes
B. The leaves learned a dance
C. The leaves moved in the wind
D. The leaves listened to music

30. What is a character trait?

A. A single event in the plot
B. A quality that describes a character
C. The final page
D. The place a story happens

31. Which action best shows kindness?

A. Mina hid the classroom books.
B. Mina laughed when someone fell.
C. Mina refused to share supplies.
D. Mina helped a new student find class.

32. What does a character's response to a problem help readers understand?

A. The number of pages
B. The book's price
C. The author's handwriting
D. The character's traits and choices

33. Which is an example of a central message?

A. Honesty can help people build trust.
B. The story has six chapters.
C. The dog is brown.
D. The events happen on Monday.

34. What is a book's genre?

A. The type or category of literature
B. The main character's mood
C. The author's first name
D. The final event

35. Which clue best helps identify a story's setting?

A. The page color
B. The description of the place and time
C. The number of words in the title
D. The author's photograph

36. What is a narrator's point of view in first person?

A. The narrator knows only the future
B. The narrator is a character who tells about personal experiences
C. The story has no narrator
D. The narrator is always the villain

37. Which sentence uses a simile?

A. The snow was a blanket.
B. The snow sparkled like diamonds.
C. The snow whispered.
D. The snow covered the road.

38. Which sentence uses personification?

A. The alarm clock showed seven.
B. The alarm clock was round.
C. I set the alarm clock.
D. The alarm clock yelled at me.

39. What is an illustration in a storybook?

A. The book's index
B. A picture that helps show the story
C. The author's signature
D. The list of chapters

40. How can illustrations help readers?

A. They prove every story is true
B. They can provide clues about characters, setting, or events
C. They always tell the ending
D. They replace every word

41. What is the climax of a story?

A. The list of characters
B. A major turning point or most intense moment
C. The cover illustration
D. The author's note

42. What is the resolution?

A. A list of rhyming words
B. The title page
C. The first clue about the setting
D. The part where the main conflict is settled

43. What does it mean to compare two stories?

A. Explain only one story
B. List only the authors' birthdays
C. Identify how they are alike
D. Retell every sentence

44. What does it mean to contrast two stories?

A. Count all the pages
B. Identify how they are different
C. Copy the same paragraph
D. Find only similarities

45. Which phrase is a metaphor?

A. Time is a thief.
B. Time moves like a train.
C. Time is very important.
D. Time passed quickly.

46. Which sentence contains alliteration?

A. The dog ran home.
B. We ate lunch.
C. A bird flew away.
D. Peter picked purple plums.

47. What does “the character felt blue” usually mean?

A. The character changed color
B. The character wore blue clothes
C. The character felt cold
D. The character felt sad

48. Which is the best evidence-based answer to why a character is proud?

A. The chapter is short.
B. The story is set in a city.
C. She has brown hair.
D. She smiled and showed everyone the medal she earned.

49. What should a reader do when asked to support an answer with text evidence?

A. Ignore the question
B. Give a random opinion
C. Use only the cover
D. Point to details or words in the text

50. What is the difference between a main character and a minor character?

A. The main character is always a villain
B. A minor character tells every story
C. The main character is central to the story; a minor character plays a smaller role
D. There is no difference

Medium Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

51. Read: “Nia packed an umbrella, watched the dark clouds, and hurried home.” What can you infer?

A. She plans to go swimming
B. She knows the sky will stay clear
C. She has lost her shoes
D. She thinks rain may begin soon

52. Read: “After practicing every day, Luis played the song without missing a note.” What is the best inference?

A. The song had no notes
B. Luis disliked music
C. Practice helped Luis improve
D. Luis had never touched an instrument

53. Which detail best supports the theme that teamwork can solve problems?

A. Each student carried part of the heavy box.
B. One student refused to help.
C. The box was painted yellow.
D. The room had a clock.

54. A character returns a wallet with all its money. Which trait is best supported?

A. jealous
B. careless
C. honest
D. impatient

55. A story is told using “I opened the door and stepped inside.” What point of view is used?

A. third person
B. first person
C. omniscient only
D. second person

56. Which sentence is third-person narration?

A. Let us wonder about the path.
B. Marcus wondered whether he had taken the right path.
C. I wondered whether I had taken the right path.
D. You wonder whether you have taken the right path.

57. Which is the best summary of a story about a child who loses a library book, searches for it, and finds it under a bed?

A. The library has many shelves.
B. The book has 120 pages.
C. A child searches for a missing library book and finds it under a bed.
D. The child has a blue bedroom.

58. Which detail is most relevant when explaining why a character missed the bus?

A. The bus was painted blue.
B. The street had trees.
C. The character liked apples.
D. The character woke up late and left home slowly.

59. Which statement is a theme rather than a topic?

A. A castle
B. Courage can help people face difficult challenges.
C. A storm
D. Courage

60. Two characters both help a stranger, but one acts quietly and the other asks for praise. What can readers compare?

A. The author's handwriting
B. The number of pages
C. Only their clothing colors
D. Their motivations and ways of helping

61. In a story, the phrase “the classroom was a zoo” is a metaphor because it—

A. uses a sound word
B. gives the classroom a human action
C. compares the noisy classroom to a zoo without using like or as
D. describes a real zoo in the classroom

62. Which sentence contains personification?

A. The house had three windows.
B. The old house groaned in the wind.
C. The house was near a road.
D. The house was painted white.

63. Which sentence contains a simile?

A. The runner ran quickly.
B. The runner crossed the finish line.
C. The runner was lightning.
D. The runner was as quick as lightning.

64. What does “break the ice” most likely mean when people meet for the first time?

A. Help people feel more comfortable
B. Make the room colder
C. End a friendship
D. Break a frozen lake

65. What can the phrase “her heart sank” suggest?

A. She felt disappointed or worried
B. She felt very hungry
C. She became taller
D. Her heart moved down physically

66. Which detail best reveals a character's fear?

A. He carried a notebook.
B. He backed away when he heard the strange noise.
C. He wore a striped shirt.
D. He ate breakfast at eight.

67. Why might an author include a flashback?

A. To remove the setting
B. To list every character alphabetically
C. To show an event that happened earlier
D. To explain the book's price

68. What is the main purpose of dialogue in a story?

A. To provide only the author's opinion
B. To show what characters say and may reveal feelings or traits
C. To replace the plot entirely
D. To identify the page number

69. Which is a likely lesson of a fable in which a boastful hare loses a race to a steady tortoise?

A. Never take a walk
B. Winning depends only on luck
C. The fastest animal always wins
D. Do not underestimate others; steady effort matters

70. Which clue most strongly suggests a story is historical fiction?

A. The characters live during a past historical event.
B. The text lists facts about current weather.
C. The story gives directions for a recipe.
D. The main character is a talking cloud.

71. Which is the best way to determine a story's theme?

A. Read only the title
B. Notice repeated ideas, character choices, and how the conflict ends
C. Count the illustrations
D. Look at the author's name only

72. Which answer best uses evidence to infer that a character is responsible?

A. She likes the color green.
B. She finished her chores before going out, as she had promised.
C. She lives near a park.
D. She has a younger brother.

73. A poem repeats the phrase “I will try” at the start of several lines. What effect might this repetition create?

A. Emphasis and rhythm
B. A list of chapter titles
C. A change in setting
D. A new narrator every line

74. Which line uses alliteration?

A. Silly snakes slide silently.
B. The sky turned gray.
C. The sun is hot.
D. A child ran home.

75. Which statement compares two versions of the same folktale?

A. One book has 20 pages.
B. The author of one has a long name.
C. The cover of one is red.
D. Both feature a clever hero, but their endings differ.

76. What is a narrator who knows the thoughts of several characters most likely using?

A. second-person point of view
B. third-person omniscient point of view
C. dialogue only
D. first-person point of view

77. What does a character's change from selfish to generous most clearly show?

A. Character development
B. The rhyme scheme
C. The author's biography
D. The setting

78. Which event is most likely part of a story's rising action?

A. The conflict is fully resolved.
B. The author thanks the reader.
C. The character discovers clues while trying to solve the mystery.
D. The book's title is printed.

79. Which event is most likely part of the resolution?

A. A mysterious letter arrives.
B. The friends apologize and agree to work together again.
C. The characters meet for the first time.
D. The problem first appears.

80. Which question asks for an inference?

A. Why might the character hide the letter after reading it?
B. How many words are on the page?
C. What is the chapter title?
D. What color is the letter?

81. Which detail would best support the idea that a character is determined?

A. She forgets why she started.
B. She tries again after several failed attempts.
C. She refuses to begin.
D. She leaves at the first sign of difficulty.

82. What is the best meaning of “the news spread like wildfire”?

A. The news caused a real fire
B. The news traveled very quickly
C. The news stayed secret
D. The news moved slowly

83. Which sentence best expresses a theme?

A. The dog is named Max.
B. The story takes place in spring.
C. The friends are in fourth grade.
D. Friendship grows when people listen to one another.

84. A character says, “I’m fine,” but speaks softly and avoids eye contact after losing a game. What can you infer?

A. The character has won the game
B. The character may be upset despite the words
C. The character is excited about dinner
D. The character is speaking to a crowd

85. Which text evidence best supports that a setting is cold?

A. Frost covered the windows, and the pond was frozen.
B. Flowers bloomed beside the path.
C. Birds sang in the trees.
D. The sun warmed the sand.

86. What is the most useful way to compare two characters?

A. Examine their actions, traits, goals, and responses to problems
B. Compare only the length of their names
C. Compare the book covers only
D. Count their dialogue marks

87. Which phrase is an idiom?

A. pour water into a cup
B. walk to school
C. close the door
D. spill the beans

88. What does “a storm of applause” mean?

A. A weather forecast
B. A loud, enthusiastic burst of clapping
C. A quiet audience
D. Rain falling inside a theater

89. Which statement best distinguishes a topic from a theme?

A. A topic is always a lesson; a theme is a place.
B. A topic is a subject; a theme is a message about that subject.
C. A theme is only a character's name.
D. They always mean exactly the same thing.

90. What should a reader include in a summary?

A. Every minor detail
B. The most important events and outcome
C. Unrelated facts about the author
D. Personal opinions about each character

91. Which question focuses on character motivation?

A. What color is Amira's coat?
B. Why does Amira decide to tell the truth?
C. How many chapters are there?
D. Where does Amira live?

92. Which detail suggests a narrator is unreliable?

A. The narrator uses the word “I.”
B. The story has a setting.
C. The narrator describes a character.
D. The narrator's claims repeatedly conflict with other evidence in the story.

93. What is the effect of a cliffhanger at the end of a chapter?

A. It builds suspense and encourages readers to continue
B. It lists the story's themes
C. It explains every mystery
D. It ends all conflicts permanently

94. Which pair of words creates a rhyming pattern in a poem?

A. light / night
B. light / lamp
C. bright / brown
D. night / noon

95. Which sentence uses a metaphor?

A. The playground was a beehive of activity.
B. The playground was busy like a beehive.
C. The children played outside.
D. The playground had swings.

96. Which is the best inference from “Tari checked the clock every minute and paced near the door”?

A. Tari is waiting anxiously for someone or something
B. Tari is enjoying a quiet nap
C. Tari has forgotten the time
D. Tari is asleep

97. Why should readers distinguish important details from minor details when summarizing?

A. Minor details always explain the theme
B. A summary should be longer than the original
C. A summary should focus on what matters most to the story
D. Important details should be left out

98. Which statement best compares first-person and third-person narration?

A. They differ only in story length.
B. First person always tells the future; third person always tells the past.
C. First person has no characters; third person has one.
D. First person uses a narrator who speaks as “I”; third person refers to characters as he, she, or they.

99. Which action best shows empathy?

A. A character ignores a crying classmate.
B. A character takes someone's belongings.
C. A character laughs at another's mistake.
D. A character listens and comforts a friend who feels left out.

100. What is the strongest evidence that a character has learned from a mistake?

A. The character refuses to discuss what happened.
B. The character repeats the same mistake proudly.
C. The character blames everyone else.
D. The character changes the behavior that caused the earlier problem.

Hard Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

101. Read: “Jules tucked the wilted plant beside the sunny window and measured a cup of water. The next morning, he hurried over to inspect it.” What can you infer?

A. Jules wants the plant to stay wilted
B. Jules hopes the plant will recover and is checking its progress
C. Jules is uninterested in the plant
D. Jules plans to throw the plant away

102. A character gives away a treasured prize to comfort a disappointed friend. Which theme is best supported?

A. Friends should avoid competitions
B. Winning is the only goal
C. Prizes are always worthless
D. Kindness may matter more than personal rewards

103. A narrator describes a character as “generous,” but the character repeatedly refuses to help others. What should readers do?

A. Accept the description without considering events
B. Use the character's actions as evidence and question the description
C. Ignore all character actions
D. Assume the story has no theme

104. Which detail best supports the inference that a character is hiding something?

A. She quickly folded the note when someone entered.
B. She wore a yellow scarf.
C. She ate lunch at noon.
D. She sat beside the window.

105. Two stories show characters facing failure. In one, the character gives up; in the other, the character tries a new strategy. What is the strongest comparison?

A. Both characters succeed in exactly the same way.
B. The settings must be identical.
C. The stories must have the same theme.
D. The stories present different responses to setbacks.

106. Which is the best summary of a story in which a storm ruins a picnic, the family moves indoors, and they enjoy games together?

A. The family brought sandwiches and juice.
B. A storm changes a family picnic, but the family finds a way to enjoy time together indoors.
C. The house had a large table.
D. The storm began at noon.

107. A story begins with a character afraid of speaking, then ends with the character giving a speech to help a friend. What change occurs?

A. The character grows more courageous
B. The narrator becomes first person
C. The setting changes from town to city
D. The conflict disappears before it begins

108. Which evidence best supports the theme that honesty can repair trust?

A. After admitting the mistake, the character works to replace the damaged item and earns back a friend's trust.
B. The friends attend the same school.
C. The character owns three notebooks.
D. The damaged item is blue.

109. Why might an author tell the ending first and then explain earlier events?

A. To create curiosity about how the events led to that ending
B. To make the setting impossible to identify
C. To avoid developing characters
D. To remove all suspense

110. A narrator says, “Everyone loved my brilliant plan,” but later every character rejects it. What is a reasonable interpretation?

A. The other characters do not exist
B. The story has no conflict
C. The plan definitely succeeded
D. The narrator may exaggerate or misunderstand others' reactions

111. Which statement best explains how setting can influence plot?

A. Setting replaces character motivation.
B. Setting always reveals the theme directly.
C. Setting only provides decoration and never affects events.
D. A sudden snowstorm may prevent characters from reaching their destination and create a new problem.

112. A poem compares grief to “a heavy coat that follows me indoors.” What does this metaphor suggest?

A. The speaker is shopping for winter clothes
B. The speaker is literally wearing a coat made of grief
C. Grief feels burdensome and remains with the speaker
D. The speaker has forgotten the past

113. Which line most clearly uses personification to create a mood?

A. The hall had four doors.
B. The floor was made of wood.
C. The lights were switched off.
D. The shadows crept across the empty hall.

114. A story repeats images of locked doors whenever the main character feels trapped. What might this pattern suggest?

A. The doors are only measurements
B. The doors replace the main character
C. The doors symbolize the character's lack of freedom
D. The doors prove the story is nonfiction

115. Which answer best distinguishes a theme from a summary?

A. A summary must include no events.
B. A theme is always one character's name.
C. A theme states a broader message; a summary retells key events.
D. A theme lists every event; a summary gives only an opinion.

116. Two versions of a folktale share the same main character but differ in the character's final choice. What is most useful to compare?

A. The paper size of the books
B. The color of each cover only
C. How each ending changes the message or lesson
D. The number of letters in the title only

117. Which evidence most strongly supports that a character feels guilty?

A. He enjoys reading mysteries.
B. He avoids his friend's eyes and admits he broke the model.
C. He buys a new pencil.
D. He arrives early to class.

118. Which question requires the reader to combine text evidence with prior knowledge?

A. Which word appears in the final line?
B. How many characters speak on page one?
C. Why might the character bring a coat after seeing dark clouds?
D. What is the exact title?

119. A character claims to be fearless but trembles before entering the cave. What does this contrast reveal?

A. The character may be trying to hide fear or appear brave
B. The cave is not part of the setting
C. The character has no motivation
D. The character cannot be part of the story

120. Which sequence best describes a typical plot structure?

A. Characters, cover, publisher, page numbers, theme
B. Climax, introduction, title, glossary, setting
C. Resolution, title, author, index, glossary
D. Introduction, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution

121. An author describes a character's room as neat at the beginning and messy after a difficult week. What might the change imply?

A. The narrator has disappeared
B. The character has moved to another planet
C. The story no longer has a setting
D. The character's situation or feelings have changed

122. Which statement is the strongest inference from “Mara rehearsed her apology in the mirror, then walked to her brother's room holding the broken toy”?

A. She wants to hide the toy forever
B. She intends to apologize for damaging the toy
C. She plans to blame her brother
D. She does not know what happened

123. Why is a character's response to the climax important?

A. It removes the need for a setting
B. It tells readers the author's age
C. It can reveal growth and help resolve the central conflict
D. It always introduces a new narrator

124. A story uses a child narrator who misunderstands an adult conversation. What effect might this have?

A. Readers may understand more than the narrator and notice dramatic irony
B. Readers cannot infer anything
C. The story must be a poem
D. The plot has no conflict

125. Which detail best supports the interpretation that a character values fairness?

A. She insists that everyone gets an equal turn, including a newcomer.
B. She likes blue notebooks.
C. She remembers the time of day.
D. She chooses the largest chair.

126. Which statement best explains how dialogue can develop plot?

A. Dialogue always repeats the setting.
B. Dialogue cannot reveal a character's feelings.
C. A character's words reveal a secret that changes what others do next.
D. Dialogue only fills empty space.

127. A story's theme is “small acts can make a big difference.” Which event best supports it?

A. One student's welcome helps a new classmate feel included and make friends.
B. A student buys a large backpack.
C. A teacher writes the date on the board.
D. A class takes a long test.

128. Which option best compares a poem and a short story about courage?

A. Compare only the number of pages
B. Ignore each work's details
C. Compare how each uses language, events, and speakers to develop courage
D. Assume both have identical structures

129. A poet uses “crack,” “clang,” and “whoosh.” What do these sound words mainly contribute?

A. They establish a rhyme scheme in every case
B. They identify the narrator's age
C. They help readers imagine sounds and make the scene vivid
D. They explain the ending directly

130. Which phrase is an idiom whose meaning differs from its literal words?

A. hit the books
B. read a book
C. carry a book
D. open the book

131. Which inference is best supported by “The team stayed after practice, reviewed each mistake, and tried the drill again”?

A. The team wants to stop playing
B. The team dislikes learning
C. The team is committed to improving
D. The team has already won every game

132. What is the most reliable way to identify a story's central message when several events occur?

A. Use only the last word
B. Look for ideas repeated across the events and consider the outcome
C. Count how many pages contain dialogue
D. Choose the first character mentioned

133. Which statement best explains the effect of a first-person narrator's limited knowledge?

A. The setting becomes unimportant
B. Readers automatically know every character's thoughts
C. The narrator cannot be a character
D. Readers learn events through that character's experiences and may not know what others think

134. A character's words sound cheerful, but the author describes a clenched jaw and tears. What should readers consider?

A. Only dialogue can ever be evidence
B. The actions and description may reveal feelings that words hide
C. The description is unrelated to characterization
D. The character must be laughing happily

135. Which comparison is most meaningful when studying two characters who make the same choice for different reasons?

A. Compare only the length of their names
B. Compare only their ages
C. Ignore the results of their choices
D. Compare their motivations and how those motives affect the outcome

136. Which is the best text-based explanation of why a character changes her mind?

A. She changes her mind for no reason, regardless of the text.
B. She changes because the story is long.
C. She hears new evidence and recognizes that her earlier assumption was mistaken.
D. She changes her mind because the reader prefers it.

137. Which statement is an inference rather than an explicitly stated fact?

A. The character may be worried because she keeps checking the time.
B. The character checked the clock three times.
C. The meeting begins at four.
D. The room has two windows.

138. A story ends with the same image that appeared at the beginning, but its meaning has changed. What effect can this create?

A. It proves that no events occurred
B. It removes the story's theme
C. It means the setting was never important
D. It highlights how the character or situation has changed

139. Which question best helps determine whether an event is central to the plot?

A. Is this event on an odd-numbered page?
B. Does the event use a long word?
C. Would removing this event change the main conflict or its resolution?
D. Does this event mention a color?

140. What is the best reason to cite specific details when explaining a theme?

A. The details show how the message develops in the story
B. The details make every interpretation automatically correct
C. The details prove the author is a character
D. The details replace the need to explain

141. A character's repeated attempts to fix a mistake eventually succeed. Which theme is most strongly supported?

A. Success happens without effort
B. Mistakes should never be discussed
C. Friends should avoid helping
D. Persistence can help people overcome difficulties

142. Which sentence creates suspense most effectively?

A. Niko's room had a blue rug.
B. Niko ate toast for breakfast.
C. Niko placed a book on the shelf.
D. A floorboard creaked behind Niko, though he knew he was alone.

143. Why might an author include a minor character who challenges the main character's beliefs?

A. The challenge can prompt conflict, reflection, or growth
B. The minor character must become the narrator
C. The story no longer needs a plot
D. The challenge guarantees a happy ending

144. Which interpretation of “the city swallowed him” is most reasonable in a story about someone feeling lost in a crowd?

A. The city became the narrator
B. The city literally ate the character
C. The city made him feel overwhelmed and unnoticed
D. The character moved into a mouth

145. What is the strongest basis for comparing themes across two stories?

A. Assume similar characters guarantee identical themes
B. Compare only the titles
C. Use each story's events, choices, and endings to explain the messages
D. Use personal opinion without evidence

146. Which statement best describes how imagery affects a story?

A. Sensory details help readers picture, hear, feel, smell, or taste the scene
B. Imagery is only the list of characters
C. Imagery always tells readers the moral directly
D. Imagery removes all figurative language

147. A story shows a character refusing help at first, then accepting it to solve a problem. What might the character learn?

A. Independence always means refusing everyone
B. The setting is more important than people
C. Problems cannot be solved
D. Cooperation can be a strength

148. Which response best demonstrates a careful inference?

A. Repeat the question only
B. State a likely conclusion and point to the details that support it
C. Make a guess without mentioning clues
D. Choose the most dramatic answer

149. Why might a story's resolution leave one question unanswered?

A. The author may want readers to reflect or imagine what happens next
B. An unanswered question means there is no plot
C. Every story must explain every detail
D. The characters no longer matter

150. Which choice best explains why a reader should revisit an earlier scene after learning new information at the end?

A. Earlier scenes never matter after the ending
B. The story must have changed its setting
C. The new information may change how the reader understands earlier events
D. The reader should ignore the ending

Answer Key

Answers match the randomized options in the question sections.

Easy

1. B 2. B 3. C 4. A 5. C
6. D 7. D 8. B 9. C 10. D
11. B 12. A 13. B 14. A 15. A
16. D 17. D 18. D 19. C 20. D
21. C 22. C 23. D 24. B 25. C
26. B 27. B 28. C 29. C 30. B
31. D 32. D 33. A 34. A 35. B
36. B 37. B 38. D 39. B 40. B
41. B 42. D 43. C 44. B 45. A
46. D 47. D 48. D 49. D 50. C

Medium

51. D 52. C 53. A 54. C 55. B
56. B 57. C 58. D 59. B 60. D
61. C 62. B 63. D 64. A 65. A
66. B 67. C 68. B 69. D 70. A
71. B 72. B 73. A 74. A 75. D
76. B 77. A 78. C 79. B 80. A
81. B 82. B 83. D 84. B 85. A
86. A 87. D 88. B 89. B 90. B
91. B 92. D 93. A 94. A 95. A
96. A 97. C 98. D 99. D 100. D

Hard

101. B 102. D 103. B 104. A 105. D
106. B 107. A 108. A 109. A 110. D
111. D 112. C 113. D 114. C 115. C
116. C 117. B 118. C 119. A 120. D
121. D 122. B 123. C 124. A 125. A
126. C 127. A 128. C 129. C 130. A
131. C 132. B 133. D 134. B 135. D
136. C 137. A 138. D 139. C 140. A
141. D 142. D 143. A 144. C 145. C
146. A 147. D 148. B 149. A 150. C